TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

# Tell How You Got to Where You Are in Your Career

Narrate | PPF | Story Interview

Name: _____ Date: _____

## SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

**Tell a new colleague how you got into your line of work: when and where it started, the steps in order, what you do now and what is next.**

| | |
|---|---|
| WHO | You work in a small company in Johor Bahru. This week a new sales assistant joined Kumar's team. |
| SITUATION | On Friday, Kumar takes everyone to lunch at the mamak to welcome him. The new assistant asks you: "So how did you get into this line of work?" Kumar says: "Yes, tell us. I don't know the story either!" |
| NEED | Neither of them knows your past. They need to hear when and where you started, the steps in order, and what you do now, in about one minute. |
| GOAL | Tell how you got to where you are: how it started → the steps → now → what's next, and answer one simple question. |

## SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: "So, how did you get into this line of work? Tell us, I don't know the story either!" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

## SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Ten years ago, I was a cashier at a hardware shop in Skudai. Then the owner asked me to do his accounts, so I took a night course. After that, I came here. Now I'm an accounts assistant. Every month, I check about 200 invoices and pay everyone's expense claims. Next year, I'd like to start a diploma in accounting, so one day I can be an accountant. The one thing I'm still learning is our new accounts software. At the moment, I ask Ali for help about once a week.

P PAST · HOW IT STARTED

P PRESENT · WHERE I AM NOW

F FUTURE · WHAT'S NEXT

! STILL LEARNING

## SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells a customer how he got into sales. Put his sentences in order: Past → Present → Future → Still learning.

- ☐ Eight years ago, I drove a delivery lorry for a furniture shop in Kulai. Then the owner moved me to sales.
- ☐ These days, I look after about 60 customers, and I visit five or six of them every week.
- ☐ Next year, I'd like to do a short course in online marketing.
- ☐ The one thing I'm still learning is writing long emails. At the moment, Siti checks them for me.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · how it started · **P** = Present · where I am now · **F** = Future · what's next · **!** = Still learning

## SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

### SET THE SCENE

- [ ] Ten years ago, I was …
- [ ] In 2014, I was …
- [ ] After SPM, I worked as …
- [ ] My first job was at …

### TELL THE STEPS IN ORDER

- [ ] Then …
- [ ] After two years, …
- [ ] After that, I …
- [ ] …, so I …

### WHERE I AM NOW

- [ ] Now I'm …
- [ ] These days, I …
- [ ] Every week, I …
- [ ] I came here … years ago.

### WHAT'S NEXT · STILL LEARNING

- [ ] Next year, I'd like to …
- [ ] One day, I hope to …
- [ ] I'm still learning …
- [ ] The one thing I'm still learning is …

### LISTENER: ASK AND CHECK

- [ ] Sorry, which year was that?
- [ ] Why did you change?
- [ ] What's next for you?
- [ ] So you started as …

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## SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I was a cashier for two years. [ For example, / Then / Because ] I moved to accounts.

2. The owner asked me to do his accounts. [ or / so / for example, ] I took a night course.

3. I was 19. [ When … / But … / So … ] I got my first job in Skudai.

4. I finished the night course. [ Or / After that, / For example, ] I came to this company.

## SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Ten years ago, I _____ a cashier at a hardware shop. (Setting the scene, long ago)
   - ○ be
   - ○ been
   - ○ was
2. The owner asked me to do his accounts, so I _____ a night course. (One step in the story)
   - ○ taken
   - ○ took
   - ○ taking
3. These days, I _____ about 200 invoices a month. (What you do now, every month)
   - ○ check
   - ○ am check
   - ○ checking
4. At the moment, I _____ still learning the new software. (Something still going on)
   - ○ do
   - ○ am
   - ○ have

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## SLIDE 09 The steps, then now

The steps of your story are finished: Past (was, got, took, came). What you do now or every week: Present (work, check). Something still going on: am / is + -ing.

Ten years ago, I **was** a cashier in Skudai.

Then I **took** a night course, and after that I **came** here.

These days, I **check** about 200 invoices a month.

I'**m** still **learning** the new software.

SLIDE 10

# Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · HOW IT STARTED

… years ago, I was … at … Then … After that, …

P

PRESENT · WHERE I AM NOW

Now I'm … Every week, I …

F

FUTURE · WHAT'S NEXT

Next year, I'd like to …

!

STILL LEARNING

The one thing I'm still learning is …

SLIDE 11

# Story Interview

Tell the career story on your card. Your listener cannot see it: they ask how you got into this line of work, write the steps in order, ask one question and say the story back.

1. Quiet minute: number the facts on your card in order. Round 1 (3:00 each): start → steps → now → next.
2. Listener: fill the note; number the lines 1–4 in the order you heard them. Ask one question. Say it back. Swap.
3. New partners (line B moves one seat). Round 2 (2:00 each): same story, shorter, next column. Aim: numbers 1, 2, 3, 4.
4. New partners. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: speaker's workbook shut, card face down. Listener writes the jobs.

**Card 1 · A job in a factory**

**Card 2 · A food business**

**Card 3 · A job in property**

**Card 4 · A job in a kitchen**

Listener's note: the career story

| | ROUND 1 | ROUND 2 | ROUND 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Start: when, where?** | | | |
| **Then: what changed?** | | | |
| **Now: what job?** | | | |
| **Next or still learning** | | | |

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

## SLIDE 12 Respond

Kumar asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. How long were you in your first job?
2. Why did you change?
3. What's next for you?

Start with: **I was there for about … years.** · **I changed because …** · **Next year, I'd like to …**

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## SLIDE 13 Transfer

At an open house, a friend of your cousin asks: "How did you start playing badminton?" (Or cooking, running, fishing, or a small side business.) Tell how it started, what changed, what you do now and what's next.

**It started … years ago, when I …** · **Then …** · **These days, I …** · **Next, I'd like to …**

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## SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Starts by saying when and where it began, before the first event.
- [ ] Tells the steps in an order the listener can write down, with time words (then, after that, after two years).
- [ ] Says what they do now and what is next.

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SLIDE 15

# Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Clear start (when, where) | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Steps in order | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Now and next | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Useful expressions | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Confidence | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |

**My improvement action:** Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

**After class: open the After class review**

SLIDE 11

# Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

**Card 1 · A job in a factory**

You are a new colleague. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

**Card 2 · A food business**

You are a customer who comes every week. Ask: “How did you start this business?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

**Card 3 · A job in property**

You are a client looking for a home. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

**Card 4 · A job in a kitchen**

You meet your partner on a training day. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

SLIDE 11

# Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

**Card 1 · A job in a factory**

Still learning: writing reports · 2019: a colleague hurt his hand; you wanted to stop accidents · Now: safety officer, same factory · 2014: after SPM, machine operator in Pasir Gudang · 2020: safety course · Next: teach first aid

**Card 2 · A food business**

Next: a small shop · 2021: left the office job · Now: kuih stall, Sunday market, Taman Pelangi · 2015: clerk at a travel agent, JB · Still learning: selling online · 2020: office closed 2 months; you made kuih; neighbours loved it

**Card 3 · A job in property**

Now: property agent, 15 homes a year · 2017: bought your first condo; a great agent · Next: your own office · 2012: bank teller, Kluang · Still learning: videos · 2018: passed the agent exam; weekends only · 2019: left the bank

**Card 4 · A job in a kitchen**

2016: moved to the café for better pay · Still learning: baking bread · 2011: washed plates in a hotel kitchen in JB · Next: a food truck · Now: head cook at a café in Mount Austin · 2013: a chef taught you Western food